

2026

Form 1040-ES



Estimated Tax for Individuals

Purpose of This Package

Use Form 1040-ES to figure and pay your estimated tax for 2026.

Estimated tax is the method used to pay tax on income that isn't subject to withholding (for example, earnings from self-employment, including gig economy work, interest, dividends, rents, alimony, etc.). In addition, if you don't elect voluntary withholding, you should make estimated tax payments on other taxable income, such as unemployment compensation and the taxable part of your social security benefits.

Preprinted vouchers. If you made estimated tax payments for 2025, this package may contain vouchers that are preprinted with your name, address, and SSN.



If your name or SSN isn't correct, make the necessary changes on the vouchers. Cross out the name and SSN of a deceased or divorced spouse.

Change of address. If your address has changed, file Form 8822, to update your record.

Future developments. For the latest information about developments related to Form 1040-ES and its instructions, such as legislation enacted after they were published, go to [IRS.gov/Form1040ES](https://www.irs.gov/Form1040ES).

Who Must Make Estimated Tax Payments

The estimated tax rules apply to:

- U.S. citizens and resident aliens;
- Residents of Puerto Rico, the U.S. Virgin Islands, Guam, the Commonwealth of the Northern Mariana Islands, and American Samoa; and
- Nonresident aliens (use Form 1040-ES (NR)).

General Rule

In most cases, you must pay estimated tax for 2026 if both of the following apply.

1. You expect to owe at least \$1,000 in tax for 2026, after subtracting your withholding and refundable credits.
2. You expect your withholding and refundable credits to be less than the smaller of:
 - a. 90% of the tax to be shown on your 2026 tax return, or
 - b. 100% of the tax shown on your 2025 tax return. Your 2025 tax return must cover all 12 months.

Note: These percentages may be different if you have income from farming or fishing or are a higher income taxpayer. See *Special Rules*, later.

Exception. You don't have to pay estimated tax for 2026 if you were a U.S. citizen or resident alien for all of 2025 and you had no tax liability for the full 12-month 2025 tax year. You had no tax liability for 2025 if your total tax was zero or you didn't have to file an income tax return.

Special Rules

There are special rules for those who have income from farming and fishing, for certain household employers, and for certain higher income taxpayers.

Farming and fishing. If at least two-thirds of your gross income for 2025 or 2026 is from farming or fishing, substitute 66²/₃% for 90% in (2a) under *General Rule*.

Household employers. When estimating the tax on your 2026 tax return, include your household employment taxes if either of the following applies.

- You will have federal income tax withheld from wages, pensions, annuities, gambling winnings, or other income.
- You would be required to make estimated tax payments to avoid a penalty even if you didn't include household employment taxes when figuring your estimated tax.

Higher income taxpayers. If your adjusted gross income (AGI) for 2025 was more than \$150,000 (\$75,000 if your filing status for 2026 is married filing separately), substitute 110% for 100% in (2b) under *General Rule*, earlier. If at least two-thirds of your gross income for 2025 or 2026 is from farming or fishing, this rule doesn't apply.

Increase Your Withholding

If you also receive salaries and wages, you may be able to avoid having to make estimated tax payments on your other income by asking your employer to take more tax out of your earnings. To do this, file a new Form W-4, Employee's Withholding Certificate, with your employer.

Generally, if you receive a pension or annuity, you can use Form W-4P, Withholding Certificate for Periodic Pension or Annuity Payments, to start or change your withholding from these payments.

You can also choose to have federal income tax withheld from certain government payments (see Form W-4V, Voluntary Withholding Request) or from nonperiodic payments and eligible rollover distributions (see Form W-4R, Withholding Certificate for Nonperiodic Payments and Eligible Rollover Distributions).



You can use the Tax Withholding Estimator at [IRS.gov/W4App](https://www.irs.gov/W4App) to determine whether you need to have your withholding increased or decreased.

Additional Information You May Need

You can find most of the information you will need in Pub. 505, Tax Withholding and Estimated Tax, and in the 2025 Instructions for Form 1040.